

Body

Diego Rincón

Independent

Abstract

The body is not the container of the mind. It is the condition of skill, attention, and practice. What the body does cannot be abstracted from the body. The abstraction is useful. It is not the thing.

The surgeon's hands know the tissue. Not as information. As resistance. The hands have met the tissue enough times to anticipate it, to feel the difference between this tissue and the model of this tissue.

The model is a useful abstraction. The hands know the difference between the model and the thing. That knowledge is in the hands.

—

Polanyi's cyclist knows how to balance. The balance is not a procedure. It is not a description. It is not a representation. It is a state of the body that the body achieves through having fallen enough times.

The fallen times are in the body. They are not in any description of balance. They are not transferable through description.

—

The body is singular.

This body has these hands. These hands have met this tissue at these angles across these specific encounters. The knowledge is indexed to this body, to this history of encounter.

No other body has this exact indexing. The closest approximation is years of practice on a body of similar structure. The transfer is never complete. The body is always singular.

AI has no body. This is not an accident. It is the design. Generality requires the removal of the singular. The model is trained across instances to capture what is common. What is common is not what the body knows. The body knows what is particular.

This is not a limitation to overcome. It is the nature of two different things.

A body that has practiced for ten years and a model trained on the outputs of ten years of practice are not approximations of each other. They are different kinds of things that happen to produce similar outputs on problems where the outputs are what matter.

When the outputs are not what matter — when what matters is what happens when outputs fail, when the case is new, when the wall has not been seen before — the two things diverge.

The body is the site of skill. Skill is acquired through the body meeting resistance. Attention is trained in the body through failure. Practice is the body's process of updating itself through repeated encounter.

None of this is in the outputs. The outputs are what the body found. The body is what found it.

The body of papers is not the body. The body of papers is what the body found.

References

- [1] Rincón, D. (2026). Practice. Preprint.

- [2] Rincón, D. (2026). Attention. Preprint.
- [3] Rincón, D. (2026). Skill. Preprint.
- [4] Rincón, D. (2026). Thought Is Language in Timespace. Preprint.